



CERTIFICATION REQUIREMENTS

Internal Management System Auditor

For Exemplar Global Recognized Organizations and Individuals

Disclaimer

While every effort is made to ensure that the process for evaluating applications for certification is effective, Exemplar Global, Inc. does not accept liability for the performance, conduct, or services provided by the certified person or organization.

This certification program and associated intellectual property are subject to Exemplar Global Inc. Copyright. Apart from any fair dealing for the purposes of application, review, or reference, as permitted under the Australian and United States of America Copyright Acts, no part of this program may be reproduced by any process without the written permission of the Chief Executive Officer of Exemplar Global Inc.

Copyright © Exemplar Global Inc.



CONTENTS

CONTENTS	2
INTRODUCTION	3
PATHWAY TO CERTIFICATION – Options	3
Option 1 - Via the Individual Personnel Certification pathway	3
Option 2 - Via the Recognized Organization (RO) pathway	3
INDIVIDUAL PERSONNEL CERTIFICATION	4
Summary of information	4
Evidence requirements for Individual Personnel Certification	4
How to Apply for Individual Personnel Certification	5
Additional Information	5
RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATION	7
Summary of information	7
Evidence requirements under the Recognized Organization pathway	8
How to Apply for Certification under this pathway	8
Boundaries of Certification	8
Not already a Recognized Organization?	8
OTHER GENERAL INFORMATION	8
Work Style Assessment Self-Coaching Tool	8
How to Promote Your Exemplar Global Certification	9
APPENDIX 1 - Grades	10
APPENDIX 2 - Scopes of Certification	12
APPENDIX 3 – Summary of Certification Requirements	13

INTRODUCTION

An internal management systems auditor plays a crucial role in ensuring that an organization's processes and procedures comply with relevant standards, regulations and the needs of clients. Internal Auditors are responsible for evaluating the effectiveness of the company's internal controls, identifying risks, evaluating hazards and making recommendations for improvements based on observations, evidence and other data. Ultimately, the internal management systems auditor's work is vital in promoting transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement within the organization. It is also acknowledged that the role and operational environment in which the internal auditor operates is very different to that of an external (2nd or 3rd party) auditor.

With these thoughts in mind, Exemplar Global, along with the input of subject matter experts, developed these certification requirements to provide industry with a credible and reliable framework for recognizing the considerable skills, expertise and professionalism exhibited by internal auditors, each of whom works behind the scenes to ensure the management system continues to meet the organization's own requirements, the requirements of the Standard and is effectively implemented and maintained.

PATHWAY TO CERTIFICATION – Options

There are two certification pathways offered within this program by which individuals can achieve their credential. The pathways are outlined in the following pages, but in summary:

Option 1 - Via the Individual Personnel Certification pathway

- Individuals must meet the requirements as defined by Exemplar Global. Those who meet the requirements will be approved as Internal Management Systems Auditors and receive an individual Internal Management Systems Auditor credential.



OR

Option 2 - Via the Recognized Organization (RO) pathway

- For the Employer: After fulfilling the necessary requirements, including the definition of the Internal Auditor Recognition Requirements, the Employer achieves the status of "Recognized Organization," earning it the right to display the associated digital badge issued by Exemplar Global on its promotional and marketing materials. The Recognized Organization nominates Internal Auditors to Exemplar Global who have been objectively judged as meeting its defined requirements at an appropriate Grade.
- For the Employee of the Recognized Organization: Work towards, then meet the Internal Auditor Recognition Requirements as determined by the Organization. Once Certification has been achieved, credentialed personnel will be issued with a digital badge that displays the name of the organization and the Grade level as evidence of their achievements.



Note: an important differentiator between these two pathways is:

For those in the Recognized Organization pathway, the credential is earned by the employee but belongs to the employer and is not transferable. Whereas, under the Individual Personnel Certification pathway, the individual earns AND owns the certification.

Please read this entire guide before applying for certification.

INDIVIDUAL PERSONNEL CERTIFICATION

(Pathway option 1)

Individuals must meet the requirements as defined by Exemplar Global.

Summary of information

Grades	Description	Qualification (minimums)	Experience	Scopes Available?
Conformance Auditor (Level 2)	Audit the Management System under the direction of an Audit Program Leader	Work Style Assessment RTP: Auditor or Internal Auditor course TPECS: AU	Nil	Yes (optional) ^{^1}
Audit Program Leader (Level 3)	Manage the audit program and lead the audit team	Work Style Assessment RTP: Lead Auditor, Lead Internal Auditor, or Audit Program Leader course TPECS: AU + TL	5 Audit Days	Yes (required) ^{^1}

^{^1} Scopes are available to personnel at the Conformance Auditor or the Audit Program Leader Grade of Certification. Any Management System designated as a “Type A” by ISO, or those relating to recognized specialty Standards such as Food, Automotive and Aerospace, etc., are eligible for application.

A Training Certificate, issued by an Exemplar Global Certified Training provider, documenting the name of the course/assessments undertaken, is required to support the application.

See Appendix 2 – Scopes for additional information.

Evidence requirements for Individual Personnel Certification

Applicants must provide evidence that they meet the requirements for the Grade and Scope they are applying for. These requirements are outlined below and summarized in the table appearing in Appendix 3.

Conformance Auditor

- Work Style Assessment completed within the previous three years (see the section titled [Work Style Assessment Self-Coaching Tool](#) for additional information).
- A Certificate of Attainment (or equivalent), issued by an Exemplar Global-Certified Training Provider, stating successful completion of an Auditor or Internal Auditor course based on the ISO 19011 Standard is required as a minimum.
- If the Applicant wishes to include a Scope(s) in their Application, the Certificate of Attainment need also list/specify the associated Management System Standard(s) covered during their training/examination.

Audit Program Leader

- Work Style Assessment completed within the previous three years (see the section titled [Work Style Assessment Self-Coaching Tool](#) for additional information).
- A Certificate of Attainment (or equivalent), issued by an Exemplar Global-Certified Training Provider stating successful completion of a [Lead Auditor](#), [Lead Internal Auditor](#), [Audit Program Leader](#) or equivalent course

based on the ISO 19011 Standard, plus each of the Management System Standards included as Scopes on their Application is required as a minimum.

Note: At least one Scope shall be included in the Application at this Grade level.

See [Appendix 2 - Scopes of Certification](#) for additional information on Scopes.

A list of certified training providers can be found via the Training Provider [Search Register](#) accessed via the Exemplar Global website: www.exemplarglobal.org

How to Apply for Individual Personnel Certification

Apply online via Exemplar Global's customer portal, [ExemplarLINK](#), accessed via the Exemplar Global website, www.exemplarglobal.org. Create an account, and once your account is set up, click on the Apply for Certification button to begin the process.

All application information must be provided in English unless otherwise agreed with Exemplar Global. Where translations of documents are provided, these must be independently verified for accuracy. Should you have any questions regarding what is required for the personnel certification requirements, contact Exemplar Global at support@exemplarglobal.org

Applicants who require medical, disability, language, or religious-related accommodations to assist them in applying for certification may request these accommodations by emailing details to support@exemplarglobal.org prior to commencing their application, where reasonable requests will be reviewed by a member of the Exemplar Global team.

Additional Information

General

- An Application Fee is required for a new certification application.
- Payments are to be made in U.S. dollars, except when the applicant is from Australia, in which case, Australian Dollars are accepted.
- Certification is "continuous," which means that your certification remains valid so long as you:
 - Continue to meet the scheme and grade requirements
 - At times, additional requirements may be instituted if a certification program's requirements have been significantly changed due to industry changes or other requirements relating to Scopes (for instance, a new version of a Standard).
 - Complete any necessary assessments.
 - Adhere to the Exemplar Global Code of Conduct (available via: [link](#))
 - Pay your fees. *Certification fees are paid annually by credit or debit card via the Exemplar Global Link portal.*
 - **All fees are non-refundable and subject to change.**
 - Every third year, all individuals are required to demonstrate evidence of completing the Work Style Assessment for Auditors at some point within the previous three years. Additional information relating to [Work Style Assessment](#) is outlined below.

To protect the reputation of Exemplar Global and other certified individuals, certification will be suspended or withdrawn if these requirements are not fulfilled.

Continuing Professional Development

Exemplar Global strongly encourages the completion of Continuing Professional Development relevant to your role and/or profession, and we provide numerous opportunities for professional development. Individuals should consider their personal strengths and weaknesses when selecting the appropriate professional development. Professional development activities should relate to the field of work undertaken by the certified individual.

Upgrade your certification to a higher grade (Expansion application)

You may apply to upgrade your personnel certification to a higher grade anytime. Submit your expansion application via your [online portal](#). There is a small administrative fee associated with Applications for Expansion during your current certification period.

Reducing a Certification

At any time, you may reduce your certification to a lower Grade or remove a Scope from your certification program by contacting an Exemplar Global Examiner. The Examiner may also recommend a reduction in certification to an applicant after evaluation of an initial application. Acceptance of a reduction of certification must be provided to the examiner in writing by the applicant. No fees are refunded when reducing certification.

Transitioning to Exemplar Global

If you are a management system auditor certified by one of the bodies listed below and want to transition to Exemplar Global certification or hold dual certification, Exemplar Global will formally recognize your Auditor Certification.

- Chinese Certification & Accreditation Association (CCAA)
- International Register of Certified Auditors (IRCA)
- Korean Auditor Registration (KAR)
- Professional Evaluation and Certification Board (PECB)
- ASQ Certified Quality Auditor (ASQ CQA)

There is no transition fee; however, an Application Fee will be payable. You must provide evidence of current certification in the form of a current card, certificate, or official letter from the authorizing body. **Invoices and receipts will not be accepted.** The certification granted will reflect the Grade and scheme you currently hold.

Please note that additional requirements and fees may be applicable if you apply for a higher Grade of certification. The transition process is simple and will allow you to become Exemplar Global certified quickly. To begin the process, contact an Exemplar Global team member via support@exemplarglobal.org.

RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATION

(Pathway option 2)

If individuals are employed by an organization that participates in Exemplar Globals' Recognized Organization Program, they are eligible for certification via this pathway providing they meet the qualification requirements defined and published by their organization (previously agreed to by Exemplar Global under the Recognized Organization process).

Summary of information

Grades	Description	Qualification	Experience	Scopes Available?
Provisional Auditor (Level 0)	Participate in the audit process under supervision	Work Style Assessment Nomination by Employer	Nil	No
Compliance Auditor (Level 1)	Assess compliance against internal requirements	Work Style Assessment Meet Recognized Organization defined requirements Nomination by Employer	Defined by the organization	No
Conformance Auditor (Level 2)	Audit the Management System under the direction of an Audit Program Leader	Work Style Assessment Meet Recognized Organization defined requirements Nomination by Employer	Defined by the organization	Yes (optional) ^{^2}
Audit Program Leader (Level 3)	Manage the audit program and lead the audit team	Work Style Assessment Meet Recognized Organization defined requirements Nomination by Employer	Defined by the organization	Yes (required) ^{^2}

^{^2} Scopes are available to personnel at the Conformance Auditor or the Audit Program Leader Grade of Certification. However, only those Management Systems Standards appearing on the organization's Certificate of Certification can be awarded to personnel as Scopes under this scheme.

See Appendix 2 – Scopes for additional information.

Evidence requirements under the Recognized Organization pathway

The evidence and other requirements that need to be satisfied for certification under the Recognized Organization pathway have been determined by the Recognized Organization and are, therefore, available from the Employer, or from Exemplar Global following verification of your employment [by the organization].

Note: Only nominations forwarded to Exemplar Global by a Recognized Organization will be acknowledged under this program.

How to Apply for Certification under this pathway

Apply internally via the Recognized Organization.

The Recognized Organization will perform the pre-certification process and, once all requirements have been met, recommend to Exemplar Global that the individual be certified to a specific Grade and Scope (if applicable) of Certification.

Boundaries of Certification

Internal Auditors certified under the Recognized Organization pathway are only recognized to undertake Internal (1st party) Management System Systems Audits on behalf of their own organization.

Not already a Recognized Organization?

If your organization is not yet recognized by Exemplar Global but is interested in becoming one, please contact the Exemplar Global Sales Team at support@exemplarglobal.org for additional information.

OTHER GENERAL INFORMATION

Work Style Assessment Self-Coaching Tool

All applicants are required to complete the Work Style Assessment self-coaching tool as part of the certification and recertification process. The Work Style Assessment is a sophisticated career and self-coaching development tool that empowers auditors through self-awareness. The assessment provides insight into your individual strengths as an auditor, as well as coaching and managing considerations you may consider for the benefit of your auditing career and professional development. The Work Style Assessment provides evidence that you possess the appropriate work values, style, and attitude attributes related to those defined in ISO 19011. These include:

- The degree to which you are competitive and take charge
- The degree to which you are focused on achieving challenging goals
- The degree to which you are calm and even-tempered
- The degree to which you desire and are comfortable with social interaction
- The degree to which you are sensitive to the feelings of others and are empathetic
- The degree to which you are detail-focused, organized, and methodical
- The degree to which you are curious, imaginative, and open to new ideas.

Completing the Work Style Assessment

- Exemplar Global will send you details on how to complete the Work Style Assessment when it receives your

application.

- You can take the Work Style Assessment online on your computer or mobile device.
- The assessment takes approximately 15 minutes; however, there is no time limit.
- You will be asked to answer questions based on your first impression. There are no right or wrong answers, and there is no pass or fail. It's all about better understanding yourself.
- Responses are automatically processed, and a PDF report will be emailed within one hour of completing the survey.
- If you completed the Work Style Assessment within the three years before applying, further assessment is not required.

How to Promote Your Exemplar Global Certification

Once awarded your certification, you will be issued a digital badge published by Exemplar Global that is aligned with the Certification Scheme and Grade that you have achieved. While the badge design is consistent for all people holding the same certification, the badge itself is a digital credential. It is, therefore, uniquely yours, enabling interested parties to verify your credentials simply by clicking on the badge. Along with the ability to verify your certification status, interested parties are also provided with a brief overview of the requirements needed to achieve the award.

Because it is 'portable', your Exemplar Global digital badge allows you to promote your credentials with your networks in a simple and trusted way by sharing it on your social media accounts (LinkedIn, Facebook, Twitter), via email, and by embedding it in your email signature or website etc.

So, look out for badging-related emails soon after you receive your certification. These emails provide the details on how to access the badging platform and access and share the badge itself. (Please note this communication will come from our badging partner and leader in the digital credential space, Credly). When sharing your badge on social media, please tag Exemplar Global in your posts so we can see it, too. To tag us in your posts, please insert the @ symbol before typing in 'Exemplar Global.'

Visit the [Digital Badging](#) page on the Exemplar Global website for a full list of all the digital credentials offered.

APPENDIX 1 - Grades

A Grade is a specific level within the hierarchy of a personnel certification program, with each successive Grade aligned to a corresponding higher level of expertise/skill/knowledge required to be demonstrated through the application process. Each Grade within the Certification Program has been designed to align with a specific job function. The Grades of Certification available within this Internal Management Systems Auditor Scheme are:

Provisional Auditor

(Level 0 - only available within the Recognizer Employer pathway)

Role description: Auditors who have recently joined an Audit Team and who wish to commence the process of actively working towards meeting the requirements of a higher Grade.

Note: This grade is only available under the Recognized Organization Program and can be held by the individual for up to 12 months.

Typical tasks completed at this Grade: Perform audit tasks under the direct supervision of a competent party and undertake formal and/or informal training as required by the Recognized Organization as necessary to move to a higher Grade.

Compliance Auditor

(Level 1 - only available within the Recognizer Employer pathway).

Role description: Individuals holding this Grade are deemed competent to assess the compliance of some output against the organization's own procedure or specification (internal compliance) and may act alone or as a member of a team.

Typical tasks completed at this Grade: Individuals operating at this Grade are required to:

- Act independently (without undue influence).
- Implement the audit risk management plan developed by the Audit Program Manager.
- Identify and eliminate hazards that the Auditor may be exposed to during the process of auditing.
- Understand the Procedure or Specifications of the output being audited.
- Follow the sample selection process as designed by the Audit Program Leader.
- Document accurate, sufficient, and traceable audit evidence.
- Evaluate audit samples against the Procedure or Specification.
- Form an objective opinion regarding the level of compliance with the requirement being audited.
- Where appropriate, use an appropriate technique to perform a root cause analysis where deviations from compliance are observed.

Conformance Auditor

(Level 2 - available within both pathways and equivalent to the 'traditional' Auditor Grade of certification)

Role description: Individuals holding this Grade are deemed competent to assess the conformance of the organization's management system against a given [external] conformity assessment criterion (i.e., a Management System Standard, Client Requirement, or similar) and may act alone or as a member of a team.

Typical tasks completed at this Grade: Those performed by the Compliance Auditor, plus:

- Conduct Audit activities as directed by the Audit Program Manager to determine the degree of conformance of the organization's management system and supporting processes against the relevant standard(s), regulation(s), contract(s), programs, or other external reference documents as required.

Audit Program Leader

(Level 3 - available within both pathways and equivalent to the 'traditional' Lead Internal Auditor Grade of certification)

Role description: Individuals holding this Grade are deemed competent to manage the audit program and lead the audit team to determine the effectiveness of the management system in meeting the organization's requirements and those required by relevant standard(s), regulation(s), contract(s), programs, or other externally generated normative reference documents as required.

Typical tasks completed at this Grade: Those outlined for the Conformance Auditor Grade, plus:

- Determine the scope and objectives of the Internal Audit.
- Undertake audit planning activities to ensure the needs and expectations of interested parties are met (including identifying relevant statutory and regulatory requirements).
- Perform an audit risk and opportunity analysis, devising the actions necessary to manage these.
- Identify the resources necessary to achieve the objectives of the internal audit program, including developing audit materials, defining audit methods, selecting audit team members, etc., as needed.
- Develop effective systems for selecting and monitoring internal auditors, capable of ensuring the auditor has the necessary technical knowledge, skills, and experience for the task or assigned audit.
- Ensure audits are conducted according to the audit program, monitoring the program's performance and updating it as necessary to ensure that it continues to meet objectives.
- Review and approval of audit results.
- Planning of audit follow-up activities where necessary.
- Assessment and development of audit team competence.
- Communicate the results of the internal audit program to appropriate parties.
- Ensure documented evidence regarding audit activities is properly managed and maintained.
- Identify opportunities to improve the internal audit program.
- Use data collected and observations made, including those of the Audit Team, to identify opportunities to improve the suitability/effectiveness/efficiency of procedures and processes used by the organization.

The Audit Program Manager is also required to be the nominated point of contact with Exemplar Global for the Recognized Organization Program (where applicable).

APPENDIX 2 - Scopes of Certification

A Scope is an area of specialization to which the individual holding Certification can apply their skills and knowledge.

In the case of the Internal Management System Auditor, the area(s) of specialization is/are the 'Type A' Management System Standards and those relating to recognized specialty Standards like those relating to Food, Automotive, and Aerospace etc.

Only those individuals holding (or applying for) certification at the Grade of **Conformance Auditor** or **Audit Program Leader** are eligible to be awarded Scopes. During the application process, individuals will be required to meet the Certification Requirements outlined in this document, summarized in the table appearing at [Appendix 3](#) relative to their Grade and Certification Pathway.

Notes:

- A list of 'Type A' Standards is available here: <https://www.iso.org/management-system-standards-list.html>
- If training is required, a list of certified training providers can be found via the Training Provider Search Register accessed via the Exemplar Global website: www.exemplarglobal.org
- In the Recognized Organization pathway, only those Management Systems Standards appearing on the organization's Certificate of Certification AND acknowledged within the Recognized Organization Agreement held with Exemplar Global can be included as Scopes under this scheme.

APPENDIX 3 – Summary of Certification Requirements

Grade	Scope(s) Available at this Grade	Certification Requirements	
		Recognized Organization Pathway	Individual Certification Pathway
Provisional Auditor (Level 0)	N	- Nomination by Recognized Organization - Completion of the Work Style Assessment <i>Note:</i> This grade can be held by the individual for up to 12 months.	N/A - This Grade is not available within this Pathway.
Compliance Auditor (Level 1)	N	- Nomination by Recognized Organization - Completion of the Work Style Assessment - Each Internal Auditor needs to meet the requirements for this Grade as documented within the Recognized Organization Agreement.	N/A - This Grade is not available within this Pathway.
Conformance Auditor (Level 2)	Y	- Nomination by Recognized Organization - Completion of the Work Style Assessment - Meet the requirements for certification at this Grade as documented within the Recognized Organization Agreement.	- Completion of the Work Style Assessment - A training certificate issued by an Exemplar Global-Certified Training Provider stating the successful completion of an Auditor or Internal Auditor course based on the ISO 19011 Standard as a minimum. <i>Note:</i> If the course attended is a TPECS-Certified course, the Certificate will state the attainment or successful completion of the AU Competency Unit as a minimum. - If desired, individuals are eligible to include a Scope or Scopes in their application, provided they can demonstrate that training has also been successfully completed in each management System Standard applied for ^{Λ3}. <i>Note:</i> If the course attended is a TPECS-Certified course, the Certificate will state the attainment or successful completion of the Competency Unit descriptor associated with the Standard, such as QM, EM, 45001, IS, FS, IT, etc. - Audit Experience: Nil
Audit Program Leader (Level 3)	Y	- Nomination by Recognized Organization - Completion of the Work Style Assessment - Meet the requirements for certification at this Grade as documented within the Recognized Organization Agreement. <i>Note:</i> It is a requirement for those holding the Audit Program Leader Grade in the Recognized Organization pathway to hold each of the Scopes associated with the Audit Program that they manage.	- Completion of the Work Style Assessment Lead Auditor, Lead Internal Auditor, or Audit Program Leader course (or equivalent) covering the ISO19011 Standard and each of the Management System Standards included as Scopes in the application for certification ^{Λ3}. <i>Note:</i> If the course attended is a TPECS-Certified course, the Certificate will list the AU and TL Competency Units, AND the associated Competency Unit descriptor associated with the Management System Standard undertaken, such as QM, EM, 45001, IS, FS, IT, etc. - Audit Experience: 5 Audit Days

Notes:

^{Λ3} Training may be undertaken as a single course or as a series of courses over time.

END.